

The Point for Asia Pacific

Monday, 14 September 2026

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Top Call

China Communications Infrastructure - FCC Equipment Authorisation Update: Headed for Federal Register

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The Federal Register publication of [FR Doc. 2026-18535](#) on 11-Sep-2026 marks the final procedural step before [FCC 26-50's Third Report and Order](#) takes legal effect — approximately 30 days after this publication. Note that the substantive rules summarized below originate from the FCC 26-50 order adopted on 22 Jul 2026; today's Federal Register filing introduces no new regulatory content and serves to trigger the compliance clock and satisfy the statutory public notice requirement. We reiterate that we believe **TFC** remains the most insulated as a passive component supplier with indirect impact only among the exports-focused optical transceiver chain. **Innolight**, **DSBJ** and **Eoptolink** are not on the Covered List, and there are no formal new policies enacted as of today, which should be slightly positive to sentiment. We believe investors are looking to the next FCC update and any update from the planned late-September summit between President Trump and...

[Kyna Wong](#)

China Hardware - Key Takeaways of Shenzhen PCB Tour

Our discussions with Delton, Kinwong (603228.CN, NR) and Han's CNC (covered by Jamie Wang) highlight long equipment lead times, improving cost pass-through, and strong optical mSAP demand. We believe manufacturers that secured equipment early have a timing advantage, as newly announced capacity is likely pushed into 2029 as critical equipment lead time extends to 2 years. Customer acceptance of price increases has helped PCB makers restore margins, especially for non-AI PCBs, while CCL prices are expected to remain elevated in 2027. mSAP for optical TRX presents a growth opportunity, with Kinwong's capacity booked and Han's CNC seeing stronger-than-expected ultrafast equipment demand for 2027. Delton's orders extending into early 2027 also support improved visibility.

[Karen Huang](#) | [Kyna Wong](#) | [Jamie Wang](#) | [Kevin Chen](#)

Han's CNC (3200.HK/301200.SZ) - What's New from China PCB Tour - Ultrafast Laser Driller Demand Likely Unleashes in 2H27

We met with Han's CNC (HC) Board Secretary Mr. Zhou Xiaodong during our China PCB tour on 10 September. Although [the ultrafast laser drilling equipment revenue](#)

contribution in 1H26 was lower than expected, he is quite confident that the ultrafast laser driller demand could be unleashed in 2H27 based on: **1)** capacity expansions of mSAP SLP makers for 1.6T optical transceivers and **2)** rising adoption of M9 or PTFE CCL on Nvidia's Rubin Ultra and estimates that the total industry demand could reach 1,000 units in 2027. Mr. Zhou also thinks that its CO₂ laser drilling equipment may have chance to penetrate the AI PCB supply chain simply because of supply tightness as the key supplier Mitsubishi Electric (6503.T). We believe that HC could benefit from not only strong AIDC demand growth but also PCB technology migration. Our pecking order is [Han's Laser \(002008.SZ\)](#) > HC-H (3200.HK) > HC-A (301200.SZ).

Jamie Wang

Country Top Calls

Asia FX and Rates Strategy - Trade Idea: Malaysia – Exit 5y NDIRS Receiver

We recommend exiting our 5y MYRR NDIRS receiver that we initiated on 5 Aug'26 ([link](#)). We exit at 3.95% (vs entry: 3.71%) for total loss of -25bp (including roll & carry).

Rohit Garg | Gordon Goh

Fund Flow Insights - Breadth in Fund Flows Supported by Global and GEM Funds

In the week of 9/2/2026, bond funds saw US\$17.5bn inflow while equity funds had US\$9.8bn. Global funds, ETFs in particular, continued to be the main source of inflows, which helps support the breadth of flows to multiple regions. European funds also had US\$0.3bn inflow this week. US funds, however, had a net redemption of US\$3.9bn, which marked their third week of net outflows.

Yue Hin Pong | David T Chew | Richard W Schlatter

Haidilao International Holding Ltd (6862.HK) - Weaker-than-expected table-turn in Aug

Per HDL's investor communication on Friday (Sep 11), the company's overall table-turn declined by LSD YoY in the full-month of Aug (vs +LSD YoY in the first three weeks of Aug, per mgt on its post-1H26 results investor communication; See Citi's Aug 26 note: [Haidilao - 1H26 earnings call takeaways](#)). In our view, HDL's bigger-than-expected volatility of weekly table-turn in Aug demonstrated the soft consumption environment in China at large. On Sep 8, a member of its controlling shareholders disposed of ~4.7% of HDL's stake at HK\$10.62 (detailed below), adding more negative sentiments on the stock. Citi's reiterated segment pecking order in discretionary: **Sportswear Brands>Snack Specialty**

Retail>Hotel>Restaurants>Jewelry>Pop Toys>Home Appliance. Citi's reiterated Buy-rated stock pecking order in discretionary: **Anta>Midea>Busy**

Ming>Atour>Haidilao>YUMC>Laopu>Pop Mart (see Citi's Sep 3 sector note : [China Consumer - 1H26 Reporting Season Takeaways; Citi's Revised Pecking Orders](#))

Xiaopo Wei, CFA | Vincent Young

Singapore Exchange (SGXL.SI) - Aug-26 Stats: SDAV steady vs DDAV normalizing lower

SGX reported Aug-26 monthly statistics. Securities SDAV S\$2,164m +8%mom oscillating ~S\$2bn range since Feb-26. SDAV around SG banks reporting dates (7-11th Aug) and MSCI rebalancing had S\$3bn SDAV drove monthly turnover. However, SG banks market cap % of total listed companies rose to 36% or 5% higher than Jan-25 (pre-EQDP) and +8% higher than Sep-25 trough. This comes after two rounds of EQDP fund managers appointments in Jul-25 and Nov-25 totaling S\$3.95bn out of expanded S\$6.5bn. Derivative DDAV 1.3m -12%mom/-2%mom driven by normalization of equities products DDAV (A50 -27%, TW -19%,

SG -5%) but FX contracts due to Middle-East tensions remains well supported (INR -9%mom/+45%yoy, CNH +9%mom/+42%yoy). Stock view: Trading at 31x 12mf P/E, crossing >33x Aug-26, near JEG euphoria peak of ~35x, reflecting growing market liquidity crowding into SG financials. As SGX heads into CY2027, higher SDAV base effect driving lower growth could put lofty earnings...

[Yong Hong Tan](#)

ASEAN Agricultural Products - Raising '27 CPO px forecast to RM4.8k/mt as 'Super El Nino' beckons

We raise our '27 CPO px assumption to RM4.8k/mt (previously RM4.2k/mt), from an expected strong El Nino developing in 4Q impacting yields and strengthening prices. We expect another 10-20% CPO price upside in coming 9-12 months; note that spot CPO price has only risen by +4% since onset of El Nino as of mid-26 (vs. +17% on average during previous El Nino episodes). We reshuffle our pecking order: IOI (Buy) > FR (Buy) > KLK (Buy) > SDG (Buy). Maintain bullish stance on ASEAN CPO.

[Gan Huan Wen](#)

Bank Mandiri (BMRI.JK) - Issuance of AT1 perpetual bond, ROE accretive?

Bank Mandiri issued US\$750m of Basel III AT1 perpetual non-call 5 securities at 7.35%, resetting at the five-year benchmark plus 286.6bp. The Reg S, SGX-listed bond is rated Ba2 by Moody's. We view the deal as reasonable and supportive of capital adequacy. Standalone CAR had fallen to 17.5% at June 2026 from 19.4% at FY25, leaving only 278bp above the 14.7% requirement. The bond should increase CAR by c.90bp, lifting pro-forma CAR to around 18.5%. The decline reflects 18.8% underlying loan growth, well above the system's 12.7%, and the February deconsolidation of Bank Syariah Indonesia after Danantara assumed the Government's Dwiwarna rights. The transaction is classified as indebtedness, with tax-deductible coupons, reducing the effective cost to 5.73%. We expect it to be accretive to common equity returns once deployed, but dilutive to reported Tier 1-based ROE. Maintain Neutral on Bank Mandiri.

[Ferry Wong, CFA](#)

Airports of Thailand (AOT.BK) - The Great Debates - C-suite versus Investors in the US and Canada

We hosted AOT CEO Paweena Jariyathitipong and her C-suite team at investor meetings across Citi's GEM Conference 2026 in New York, Toronto and Boston. Investors were global infrastructure-focused as well as emerging market funds. Key debates centered on (i) traffic recovery, (ii) King Power's payment sustainability, (iii) upside initiatives. **Incremental disclosures** on-top of [C-suite's Jun26 Europe roadshow](#), [Capital Market Day in Phuket](#) and [Citi's ASEAN Summit in Aug26](#) include bank financing behind King Power's Bt9bn repayment, higher Chinese/Indian spending, third ground-handler approval and additional cost-management initiatives. **We believe** AOT prefers to provide conservative guidance given c8% operating costs increase pa. and c10-15% lower passenger volume assumed to [derive Jun26's RAB-based passenger tariff hike](#). Certain buffers are required given NO claw-back on over/under-earnings as long as AOT spends Bt85bn committed capex over the...

[Kaseedit Choonawat](#)

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Key Rating and Target Price Changes

Analyst	Company	Ccy	Closing Price	Rating			Target Price			Report
				New	Prior	Chg	New	Prior	Chg	
Gan Huan Wen	First Resources (FRLD.SI)	S\$	4.32	nc	Buy		5.35	4.00	▲	Report
Gan Huan Wen	IOI (IOIB.KL)	RM	4.80	nc	Buy		6.20	5.00	▲	Report
Gan Huan Wen	KL Kepong (KLKK.KL)	RM	22.54	nc	Buy		31.00	26.70	▲	Report
Gan Huan Wen	SD Guthrie Bhd (SDGU.KL)	RM	6.22	nc	Buy		7.70	7.60	▲	Report
Jamie Wang	Meyer Optoelectronic Tech (002690.SZ)	Rmb	15.600	nc	Neutral		16.500	20.700	▼	Report
Kevin Chen	StarPower (603290.SS)	Rmb	82.650	nc	Neutral		90.000	110.000	▼	Report
Lydia Ling	JNBY Design (3306.HK)	HK\$	21.14	nc	Buy		23.50	22.50	▲	Report
Michelle Ma, CFA	Yuanbao (YB.O)	US\$	13.91	Neutral / H	Neutral		15.50	17.90	▼	Report

nc = no change H = High Risk

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Refer to the Report for the date and details regarding the rating and/or target price change.

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Appendix A-1

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